

Comprehensive English notes from the morning current affairs class (Session date: August 5, 2026), covering the day's news updates plus the next set of questions from the Karnataka exam paper. All facts, figures, names, MCQs and quick-revision points from the session are included below.

1. Balochistan's Independence Day Claim (Viral News)

A viral social media claim states that Balochistan will celebrate its own Independence Day on **11 August** — before Pakistan (14 Aug) and India (15 Aug). No official statement has come from Pakistan or the UN yet.

- Balochistan is the **largest province of Pakistan**; capital city: **Quetta**.
- Historically it existed as the **"Republic of Balochistan"**, ruled by local kings, and the region/princely state was called the **Khanate of Kalat**.
- In 1947 Balochistan wanted to remain an independent country (neither with India nor Pakistan); by **1948** Pakistan forced it to sign accession and annexed it.
- The demand for independence dates back to **27 March 1948**.
- China is developing the **CPEC corridor** and the **Gwadar Port** in Balochistan (located on the Arabian Sea), which has intensified Baloch–Pakistan Army clashes.
- Balochistan has chosen 11 August as it is historically significant (linked to when local rulers still existed) and to mark independence before Pakistan.
- Four conditions generally required for statehood: defined **population**, a functioning **government**, capacity for **foreign relations/trade**, and a properly **defined territory** — all currently under dispute for Balochistan, so UN recognition remains uncertain.

2. Sikkim – Fully Literate State & SEHAT Scheme

- Sikkim has recently been declared a **fully literate state** under the **ULLAS Yojana** (covers a total of 6 states).
- **SEHAT** full form: **Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation**.

3. RBI – Executive Director Appointment & Structure

Monisha Chakraborty has been appointed **Executive Director (ED)** of RBI with effect from **3 August 2026**. Appointment made by the Government's Appointments Committee, with approval from the RBI Governor.

- RBI established under the **Government of India Act, 1935**; original HQ **Kolkata**, shifted to **Mumbai in 1937**.
- Structure: 1 Governor + 4 Deputy Governors + Executive Director(s).
- Current Governor: **Sanjay Malhotra** — **26th Governor of RBI**.
- Deputy Governors discussed: **Poonam Gupta, S.C. Murmu, Rohit Jain, J. Swaminathan**.
- RBI is India's **central bank** (Apex body) — note: this is different from the separately existing bank named **"Central Bank of India"**.
- **■10** currency notes are to be issued as **polymer/plastic notes**.
- Symbols on RBI seal: palm tree and the **Royal Bengal Tiger**.

4. EPFO – Training Institute

The **Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya National Academy of Social Security** (established **1990**) is an apex training institute — it provides training for the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)**.

5. Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)

Lt Gen (Dr) N.S. Rajasubramani has been appointed as India's **3rd CDS**. The **2nd CDS** was **Anil Chauhan**; the **1st CDS** was **Bipin Rawat**.

6. COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal 2026

- Awarded to **Annapurni Subramaniam** for her contribution in the field of **Astrophysics**.
- Award started in **1990**; given jointly by **ISRO** and **COSPAR** (Committee on Space Research), dedicated to **Vikram Sarabhai**, "Father of the Indian Space Programme".
- Announced at the **46th COSPAR Summit** held in **Florence, Italy**.
- Previous (2024) recipient: **Anil Bhardwaj**.
- She is the **first Indian woman** to receive this award — **4th Indian overall** and **3rd woman overall** globally.
- Past Indian awardees: **U.R. Rao (1996)**, **G.S. Lakhina (2014)**, **Anil Bhardwaj (2024)**, **Annapurni Subramaniam (2026)**.
- COSPAR has been functioning since **1958**.

7. Constitution of India Released in Sindhi

In April 2026, Vice President **C.P. Radhakrishnan** released India's Constitution in the **Sindhi language**, published in two scripts: **Devanagari and Persian** (not Gurmukhi or Gujarati).

8. Missile in the News – Russia's Cruise Missile

- A missile system named **"Bandarol"** (**Burevestnik-type**) belongs to **Russia**; reports suggest it could be used against **Odesa, Ukraine**.
- It is a **cruise missile**; Range: **500 km**; Warhead: **150 kg**; Speed: **0.5 Mach**; can be launched from the **Oreshnik** system or an **Mi-28 helicopter**.

- Russia spans **Europe and Asia**; capital: **Moscow**; part of the **Arctic Circle** region; **not a NATO member**; borders Kazakhstan, Mongolia and China.
- India–Russia joint exercise: **INDRA**. Russian-origin equipment in India: **S-400, MiG, Sukhoi**.
- India's own cruise missiles: **BrahMos** (India–Russia joint, range 290 km), **Nirbhay** (range 1000–1500 km), and **LRLACM** (Long Range Land Attack Cruise Missile, range 1000 km).

9. Polity – Fundamental Rights Matching

Match-the-following on Fundamental Rights: Equality in Public Employment, Minority Rights, Right to Personal Liberty, and Right against Exploitation (**Article 23**) with their respective Articles — solved in class as a recap of the previous session.

10. Arunachal Pradesh's First Ramsar Site – Glol Lake

- Located in **Lohit district, Arunachal Pradesh** (capital: **Itanagar**; tribes of the region include Dafla, Abor, Mishmi; also the **Nyishi community**).
- Fed by two rivers — **Kamlang** and **Lang** — both tributaries of the **Brahmaputra**.
- Rich in **orchid species**, migratory birds; local tribes: **Idu Mishmi** and **Mizo(Miju) Mishmi**; wildlife includes the **Takin**.
- **Namdapha National Park** lies to its south; **Kamlang Tiger Reserve** lies to its north.
- It is a **freshwater lake**.
- **Ramsar Convention**: held in **1971 in Ramsar, Iran**, for wetland conservation; India became a signatory in **1982**; India's first Ramsar site was **Chilika Lake, Odisha (1981)**.
- Sites 95–100 (recap): 95 Sillare (Rajasthan), 96 Koppara (Chhattisgarh), 97 Patna/Etawah-type site (UP), 98 Chari (Gujarat), 99 Shekha (UP), 100 named after Jai Prakash Ji (Aligarh, UP).
- India's total Ramsar sites now stand at **101**; announced by the **Ministry of Environment** (Minister **Bhupender Yadav**).

11. Polity – UPSC & Seventh Schedule

- UPSC members are appointed by the **President of India**.
- **Seventh Schedule** of the Constitution includes the **Union List, State List and Concurrent List**.

12. Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP)

- Launched by the **Department/Ministry of Finance** to provide **P&I (Protection and Indemnity)** insurance cover for oceans and seas.
- Falls under **UNCLOS** (United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea) — established **1982 in Jamaica**, effective from **1994**.
- Implementing insurer: **New India Assurance Company Limited** (works at the national level).
- Aim: financially support and help control **pollution** in seas/oceans; India's first government-guaranteed scheme of this kind.
- Launched from **Delhi**; investment involved: approx. **₹13,905 crore**.

13. Polity – Parliamentary Government & Emergency Provisions

- In a parliamentary system, the **Executive is directly responsible to the Legislature**.
- **Emergency provisions** are contained in **Part XVIII** of the Constitution.

14. South India's First Semiconductor Unit

- To be developed by **ASIP Technology** in **Tarluvada village, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh**.
- Investment reported around **₹2,500 crore**; being set up under **India Semiconductor Mission 1.0**.
- Note: Gujarat already hosts India's largest semiconductor hub under the National Semiconductor Policy; the world's leading semiconductor hub is in **South Korea**.

15. Important Days & Olympic Motto

- **Earth Day** – 22 April; **Ozone Day** – 16 September; also matched: Population Day and Pollution Day.
- **Olympic motto**: "**Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together**".

16. Indian Organ Donation Day

- Observed on **3 August** — marks India's **first heart transplant**, performed on **3 August 1994** by **Dr. K.M. Venu Gopal**.
- Day first observed from **2010**; organised under the **Ministry of Health**, celebrated via **NOTTO** (National Organisation for Tissue and Organ Transplant).
- Top organ-donating **state**: **Tamil Nadu**; top **North-Eastern state**: **Assam**; top **Union Territory**: **Delhi**.

17. New Catfish Species Discovered in Odisha

- Named "**Khairi**", after a tigress of the **Similipal Tiger Reserve**; full scientific name: **Pseudolaguvia khairi**.
- Found in the **Budhabalanga River**, in **Mayurbhanj district, Odisha**.
- Similipal: declared a **Wildlife Sanctuary** in **1956**, a **Biosphere Reserve** in **1994**, added to the **UNESCO list** in **2009**.
- Known for the **Red Silk Cotton tree**, locally called "**Simul**".

18. International Clouded Leopard Day & India's New Action Plan

- Observed on **4 August** — named for the cloud-like patterns on the animal's coat.

- India launched the **Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan (2026)**, in partnership with the **Global Environment Facility (GEF)** and **UNDP**.
- Announced from **Coimbatore**, at the **91st meeting of the National Board of Wildlife**.
- In India, clouded leopards are found in **Tripura** (also home to Clouded Leopard National Park).
- Only **two species** exist worldwide: **Mainland Clouded Leopard** and **Sunda Clouded Leopard**.
- Day has been celebrated since **2018**, by the **Aspinall Foundation**.
- IUCN status: **Vulnerable** (like the snow leopard); protected under the **Wildlife Protection Act, 1972**.
- M-Strip** technology used for population counting of wild species.

19. Other Appointments & Events

- Vishwesh Negi** appointed India's Ambassador to **Iran**.
- World Breastfeeding Week: 1–7 August**; 2026 theme: "Breastfeeding for a Sustainable Start in Life: Strength – What Works."

20. Quick Revision – One-Line Facts

Topic	Key Fact
Recent Egypt earthquake	Occurred along the Mediterranean coast
Anti-conversion law	Assented to by President Droupadi Murmu
Drug Free India campaign	Launched by PM Narendra Modi
Snow leopard camera-trapped	In the Dhauladhar range, Himachal Pradesh
Rotor Clap–III	Domestic defence exercise held in Rajasthan
Univ. of Western Australia campuses (India)	Mumbai and Chennai
India–China border trade	1st, 2nd and 3rd passes all reopened from 1 August
Director General, Geological Survey of India (GSI)	Varsha Ashok Ji
Commonwealth Games closing ceremony flag bearer	Asmine (boxer)

21. All MCQs Asked in the Session

Q1. Balochistan has announced it will celebrate its Independence Day on which date?

Ans: 11 August

Q2. Which is the largest province of Pakistan?

Ans: Balochistan (capital: Quetta)

Q3. Under which scheme was Sikkim declared a fully literate state?

Ans: ULLAS Yojana

Q4. What is the full form of SEHAT?

Ans: Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation

Q5. Who has been appointed Executive Director of RBI w.e.f. 3 August 2026?

Ans: Monisha Chakraborty

Q6. Which is the largest bank of India — SBI or Central Bank of India?

Ans: SBI (Central Bank of India is a separate, distinct bank, not the same as RBI)

Q7. Who is the current Governor of RBI, and which number governor is he?

Ans: Sanjay Malhotra, 26th Governor

Q8. The Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya National Academy of Social Security provides training for which organisation?

Ans: EPFO (Employees' Provident Fund Organisation)

Q9. N.S. Rajasubramani has been appointed as the 3rd CDS of India. Who was the 2nd CDS?

Ans: Anil Chauhan (1st CDS was Bipin Rawat)

Q10. Who has been honoured with the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal 2026?

Ans: Annapurni Subramaniam (for contribution in Astrophysics)

Q11. Where was the 46th COSPAR Summit (where the 2026 award was announced) held?

Ans: Florence, Italy

Q12. India's Constitution was released in the Sindhi language in which two scripts?

Ans: Devanagari and Persian

Q13. The 'Bandarol' cruise missile in the news belongs to which country?

Ans: Russia

Q14. What is the range of Russia's 'Bandarol' cruise missile?

Ans: 500 km (warhead: 150 kg; speed: 0.5 Mach)

Q15. Match the Fundamental Right 'Right against Exploitation' with its Article number.

Ans: Article 23

Q16. Which is Arunachal Pradesh's first Ramsar site?

Ans: Glol Lake (Lohit district)

Q17. In which year did India become a signatory to the Ramsar Convention?

Ans: 1982 (Convention held in 1971, Ramsar, Iran)

Q18. What is India's total number of Ramsar sites at present?

Ans: 101

Q19. Who appoints the members of the UPSC?

Ans: President of India

Q20. The Seventh Schedule of the Constitution covers which lists?

Ans: Union List, State List and Concurrent List

Q21. Which new insurance scheme has been launched by the Department of Finance to protect oceans and seas?

Ans: Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP), providing P&I; – Protection and Indemnity cover

Q22. In a parliamentary form of government, the Executive is directly responsible to whom?

Ans: The Legislature

Q23. Which Part of the Constitution contains the Emergency Provisions?

Ans: Part XVIII

Q24. South India's first semiconductor unit (by ASIP Technology) is being set up in which state?

Ans: Andhra Pradesh (Visakhapatnam)

Q25. Match the following environmental days: Earth Day, Ozone Day, Population Day, Pollution Day with their dates.

Ans: Earth Day – 22 April; Ozone Day – 16 September (others matched accordingly)

Q26. What is the Olympic motto?

Ans: Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together

Q27. When is Indian Organ Donation Day observed?

Ans: 3 August

Q28. India's first heart transplant (marked by Organ Donation Day) was performed by whom, and when?

Ans: Dr. K.M. Venu Gopal, on 3 August 1994

Q29. Which state records the maximum organ donations in India?

Ans: Tamil Nadu (NE state: Assam; UT: Delhi)

Q30. A newly discovered catfish species in Odisha has been named after which tigress?

Ans: Khairi (of Similipal Tiger Reserve); scientific name *Pseudolaguvia khairi*

Q31. In which river was the new catfish species found?

Ans: Budhabalanga River, Mayurbhanj district, Odisha

Q32. When was Similipal declared a Biosphere Reserve and added to the UNESCO list?

Ans: Biosphere Reserve – 1994; UNESCO list – 2009 (Wildlife Sanctuary since 1956)

Q33. On which date is International Clouded Leopard Day observed?

Ans: 4 August

Q34. What is the name of India's new conservation plan for clouded leopards, launched in 2026?

Ans: Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan

Q35. In partnership with which two organisations was this plan launched?

Ans: Global Environment Facility (GEF) and UNDP

Q36. From which city was the Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan announced?

Ans: Coimbatore (at the 91st National Board of Wildlife meeting)

Q37. In India, clouded leopards are mainly found in which state?

Ans: Tripura

Q38. How many species of clouded leopard exist in the world?

Ans: Two – Mainland Clouded Leopard and Sunda Clouded Leopard

Q39. What is the IUCN conservation status of the clouded leopard?

Ans: Vulnerable

Q40. Who has been appointed India's Ambassador to Iran?

Ans: Vishwesh Negi

Q41. When is World Breastfeeding Week observed?

Ans: 1–7 August

Q42. Along which coast did the recent Egypt earthquake occur?

Ans: Mediterranean coast

Q43. Who has been appointed Director General of the Geological Survey of India (GSI)?

Ans: Varsha Ashok Ji

Q44. Who carried the flag at the Commonwealth Games closing ceremony for India?

Ans: Jasmine (boxer)

Note: Additional homework questions were left for self-revision in the comment section. The current affairs magazine ("Pragyan") is available in Hindi and English on Flipkart/Amazon; a new crash course batch also began on this date.